

Projection onto interval: Real Stability

Research Architecture Runtime

operator/projection-interval

2026-07-29

Abstract

`projection-interval` uses interval clamp, which is 1-Lipschitz; hence $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$ implies the clamped values move by at most ε . Lean `LEAN_FULL`.

This theorem is: Reduction

1 Problem

`projection-interval` projects coordinates onto intervals via `clamp(x; lo, hi) = max(lo, min(x, hi))`.

2 Stability notion

Nonexpansiveness of clamp: output perturbation $\leq$ input perturbation in absolute value.

3 Definitions

Require $lo \leq hi$. Stability form is the Lipschitz claim with $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$.

4 Theorem

Theorem 1. *If $lo \leq hi$ and $|x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$, then $|\text{clamp}(x') - \text{clamp}(x)| \leq \varepsilon$. The Lipschitz constant 1 is sharp.*

5 Intuition

Clipping cannot expand distances: points move weakly toward the interval.

6 Examples

Example 2. $\text{lo} = 0$, $\text{hi} = 1$, $x = 0.4$, $x' = 0.7$, $\varepsilon = 0.3$: both clamp to themselves and move by 0.3.

7 Proof

The map $x \mapsto \max(\text{lo}, \min(x, \text{hi}))$ is 1-Lipschitz on $\mathbb{R}$ when $\text{lo} \leq \text{hi}$ (standard case analysis on the three regions $(-\infty, \text{lo}]$, $[\text{lo}, \text{hi}]$, $[\text{hi}, \infty)$). Therefore $|\text{clamp}(x') - \text{clamp}(x)| \leq |x' - x| \leq \varepsilon$ (Theorem 1). Sharpness: take an interior segment of length ε inside $[\text{lo}, \text{hi}]$.

8 Formal statement

Lean module

`Research.Operators.ProjectionInterval.Preservation`

Source file

`lean/Research/Operators/ProjectionInterval/Preservation.lean`

Theorems

- `projection\_interval\_clamp\_stability`
- `projection\_interval\_clamp\_sharpness`

Note

Uses `Projection.Clamp`.

Certificate

`lean/certificates/projection-interval/projection-interval-clamp-stability`

Status

`LEAN_FULL` on Mathlib $\mathbb{R}$ (`REAL_MATHLIB`)

9 Proof dependencies

- `Projection.Clamp` nonexpansiveness.
- Case analysis on regions.

10 Consequences

Interval/box/clipping operators reduce to clamp. Related: projection-interval, coordinate-clipping.